

Lesson 24 Inclusion-Exclusion Principle

Formula for the cardinality of a union of sets

Simplest case U : universal set; $A, B \subseteq U$

Union Rule $|A \cup B| = \underbrace{|A| + |B|}_{\text{inclusion}} - \underbrace{|A \cap B|}_{\text{exclusion}}$



double counted

2 Corollaries

① Addition Rule: When A and B are

disjoint, then $A \cap B = \emptyset$ and $|A \cap B| = 0$

$$\boxed{|A \cup B| = |A| + |B|} \quad \text{complement of } A$$

② Subtraction Rule: A and $\bar{A}$ are disjoint

By the addⁿ rule, $\underbrace{|A \cup \bar{A}|}_U = |A| + |\bar{A}|$

U : universal

$$\rightarrow \boxed{|\bar{A}| = |U| - |A|}$$

Ex $U = \{1, 2, \dots, 100\}$

$A = \text{multiples of } 3 = \{3, 6, 9, \dots, 99\}$

$B = \dots 5 = \{5, 10, 15, \dots, 100\}$

$A \cup B$: multiples of 3 or 5

$|A| = \left\lfloor \frac{100}{3} \right\rfloor (\text{floor}) = 33$

$|B| = \left\lfloor \frac{100}{5} \right\rfloor = 20$

$|A \cap B| = \left\lfloor \frac{100}{15} \right\rfloor = 6$

multiples of 15

multiple of 3 and 5
 $\uparrow$
 multiple of 15
Pq

$|A \cup B| = |A| + |B| - |A \cap B| = 33 + 20 - 6 = 47$

$\boxed{|A \cup B| = |\bar{A} \cap \bar{B}|}$ (neither multiple of 3 nor 5)

De Morgan

$$x = |U| - |A \cup B|$$

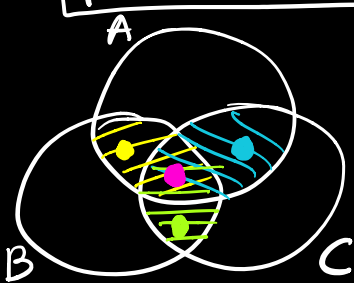
$$= 100 - 47 = 53$$

3 sets: $A, B, C \subseteq U$ (universal)

$$|A \cup B \cup C| = |A| + |B| + |C|$$

$$- |A \cap B| - |A \cap C| - |B \cap C|$$

$$+ |A \cap B \cap C|$$



Example 2 in notes

General case: $A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n \subseteq U$

$$|A_1 \cup A_2 \cup \dots \cup A_n| = \sum_i |A_i| - \sum_{i,j} |A_i \cap A_j|$$

$$+ \sum_{i,j,k} |A_i \cap A_j \cap A_k| - \dots$$

$$+ (-1)^{n+1} |A_1 \cap A_2 \cap \dots \cap A_n|$$

Version 2 (Complement) (General De Morgan's Induction)

$$|\overline{A_1 \cup A_2 \cup \dots \cup A_n}| = |\overline{A_1} \cap \dots \cap \overline{A_n}|$$

$$|\overline{A_1 \cup A_2 \cup \dots \cup A_n}| = |U| - |A_1 \cup A_2 \cup \dots \cup A_n|$$

$$\text{LHS} = |U| - \sum_i |A_i| + \sum_{i,j} |A_i \cap A_j|$$

$$- \sum_{i,j,k} |A_i \cap A_j \cap A_k| + \dots$$

$$+ (-1)^n |A_1 \cap A_2 \cap \dots \cap A_n|$$

RHS



Proof LHS counts the # of elements which are not in any A_i . We will show that RHS counts the same elements.

- An element x which is not in any A_i contributes "1" to RHS:

- x 's contribution to $|U|$ is 1

- x 's contribution to the other terms on RHS is 0

Net contribution of x to RHS is 1.

- An element y which is in at least one A_i contributes "0" to RHS: Suppose y is in exactly m A_i 's

- y 's contribution to $|U|$ is 1

- y 's contribution to $\sum_i |A_i|$ is m

- y 's contribution to $\sum |A_i \cap A_j|$ is $\binom{m}{2}$

of 2-set intersections with y in each set.

- y 's contribution to $\sum |A_i \cap A_j \cap A_k|$ is $\binom{m}{3}$

- y 's contribution to $\dots$ (intersections of m sets) is $\binom{m}{m}$

y's net contribution to RHS:

$$1 - m + \binom{m}{2} - \binom{m}{3} + \binom{m}{m} = 0$$

$\binom{m}{0}$ $\binom{m}{1}$

proved earlier

Exercise in Combinatorial proof:

the # of even-numbered subsets

= ... odd-numbered ...

$$\binom{m}{0} + \binom{m}{2} + \binom{m}{4} + \dots = \binom{m}{1} + \binom{m}{3} + \dots$$